HomeBridge COOPERATIVE
Abroad and at home, we build together.

Member Handbook

HOMEBRIDGE!!! Connecting People! · Building Trust! · Creating Wealth!

Welcome to HomeBridge Cooperative. This handbook explains, in plain English, how the cooperative works and what membership means for you. Where it refers to the Bye-laws, the Bye-laws are the final authority.

1. What HomeBridge is

HomeBridge Cooperative brings together Nigerians and Africans at home and in the diaspora to pool savings, invest together and develop our communities. It is owned by its members, not by any company or individual.

Membership is open to all, at home and abroad. HomeBridge is starting with chapters in the FCT and Edo State, with diaspora members worldwide, and plans to grow across all 36 states of Nigeria and into other African countries.

2. Who owns it and who runs it

- **The members own it.** Every member has one vote, whatever the size of their shareholding.
- **The Governing Board leads it.** It sets direction, approves budgets and oversees management.
- **The Supervisory Committee checks it.** It reviews how the Board and management follow the Bye-laws.
- **VEKAT Nigeria Ltd manages it.** As appointed manager, VEKAT handles registration, vetting, records and day-to-day administration under a contract agreed by the Board.
- **An independent external auditor** audits the accounts.

The Governance and Contacts sheet in your pack lists the current office holders.

3. Joining

Step	What happens
Apply	Complete the application form; you receive an application reference (HBA-…)
Pay the joining fee	£10 (diaspora) or ₦10,000 (home), paid once to VEKAT; you receive a receipt (VKT-RCP-…)
Vetting	VEKAT checks your identity and details
Admission	On approval you receive your permanent membership number (HBC-…) and this welcome pack
Complete your forms	Sign and return the Declaration and Nominee forms within 14 days

Every member pays the joining fee, including founding members. **The joining fee is non-refundable, including if an application is not approved.**

4. Your membership number

Your membership number, for example HBC-UK-26-00001, is yours for life. It shows your chapter, the year you joined and your place in the membership. Quote it on every payment, form, email and call. It never changes, even if you move chapter.

5. Contributing

	Home members	Diaspora members
Minimum monthly contribution	₦5,000	£25 (or USD equivalent)
Held as	Shares in your name	Shares in your name
Paid into	HomeBridge Naira account	HomeBridge GBP or USD domiciliary account
Payment reference	Your membership number	Your membership number

You may contribute more than the minimum. The Contribution and Payment Guide gives the account details.

Founding members take up a founding block of ₦2,000,000 or £1,000 and sit in the Founding Members' Forum.

> *Keep your money safe. HomeBridge only ever uses its own accounts. Nobody from HomeBridge or VEKAT will ask you to pay into a personal account. Account details only change by written notice signed by the Chairman and the Treasurer.*

6. What HomeBridge invests in

Members decide the cooperative's investment activities at General Meetings. These include a long-term, expert-advised equity portfolio. Investments carry risk, and no return is guaranteed. Please read the Investment Risk Statement in your pack.

7. Meetings and voting

- The **Annual General Meeting (AGM)** receives the accounts, elects board members and approves major decisions. The first AGM and official launch take place in the first week of December 2026.
- Every member may attend, speak and vote, in person or online where offered.
- Elected board seats rotate on three-year terms.
- Notice of meetings is sent by email and posted in the members' WhatsApp group.

8. Chapters

You belong to a chapter: your state if you live in Nigeria, or your country if you live abroad. Chapters organise local meetings and projects and report to the Board.

9. Keeping your details up to date

Tell us promptly if your phone, email, address or nominee changes. Email info@homebridge.org quoting your membership number.

10. Leaving HomeBridge

You may withdraw from membership at any time by writing to the Secretary. Repayment of your shares, notice periods and any conditions follow the Bye-laws [section to be confirmed]. If a member dies, their shares pass to the nominee(s) named on their Nominee Form, subject to the Bye-laws.

11. Complaints

Write first to the Secretary. If the matter is not resolved within 21 days, write to the Head of the Supervisory Committee. Contact details are on the Governance and Contacts sheet.

12. Contact

info@homebridge.org · 08105832602

Head office: 4 Eregbowa Street, off Trinity Road, Ugbor Quarters, Benin City, Edo State